



McCullum used to do. If any credit is due, it is solely to Rohit and nobody else.

Instead of using the words this-ball or that-ball, I would suggest using the skipper's first name, Rohit, and term it the 'Gohit' approach. Hopefully, brainier people will come up with a trendier name for this rather than the lazy option of calling it after 'Bazball'. That day's batting set the game up for India to secure a win on the final day and earn the much-needed points required to be in the race for a place in the World Test Championship (WTC) final in June next year. Would this approach have been adopted if there were no points on offer and no qualification needed for the WTC final?

Having lost two full days of play,

with the team batting first still having seven wickets in hand, not many teams in the past would have even looked at a result and would have been content to play out the remaining two days for personal records and milestones. So, full marks to the ICC for creating the World Test Championship and thereby making every Test match, including a dead rubber, important for the points teams can accrue from them. Every Test match thus has context and has livened up the long format, with teams wanting a win and looking to make things happen by trying something new and innovative.

However refreshing and thrilling the Indian batting was in the Kanpur Test match, let's face it: would they

Leading by example: Rohit Sharma's aggressive approach, both as captain and opener, has garnered praise from all sides. GETTY IMAGES

have batted in the same manner if there were no points on offer? The much-maligned ICC deserves every bit of applause for changing the perception towards every Test match by creating the World Test Championship. India know they have tough games ahead, and thus they had to try and secure maximum points while playing at home. Bangladesh are done and dusted, and now it's the Kiwis who will be in the firing line of Rohit and his boys. Will they overpower them as they did Bangladesh? We shall soon find out.



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